

Useful properties

The properties of a material are the physical characteristics that the material has, and will determine the use that it is put to. For example, glass is used to make windows because it is transparent. Transparency is one of the properties of glass.

1. For each of the following materials, state what property of the material makes it useful for the stated purpose. The first one has been done for you.

Material	Used to make...	Useful property of material
Glass	Windows	Transparency
Styrofoam	Disposable coffee cups	
Steel	Bridges	
Gold	Jewellery	
Aluminium	Saucepans	
Foam rubber	Pillows	
Sugar	Lollies	
Wood	Matchsticks	
Plastic	Shopping carrier bags	
Elastic	Hair bands	

2. Give reasons why you *wouldn't* use:

(a) plastic to make a frying pan

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(b) wood to make pillows

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(c) rubber to make a bridge

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(d) sugar to make jewellery

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(e) elastic to make matchsticks.

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